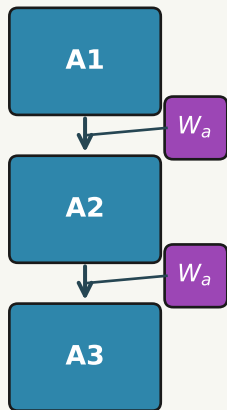


What carries the signal? Decomposing the inter-agent channel

Empirical decomposition (Exp M, GSM8K / ARC / MBPP+):

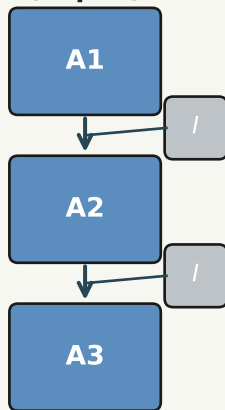
Trained $W_a \approx$ Identity W_a on GSM8K & ARC; +5.8pp on MBPP+ (McNemar $p=0.010$)

**LatentMAS
(trained W_a)**



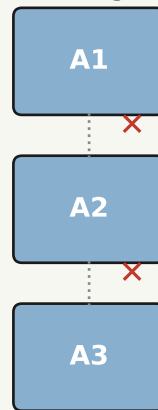
Both KV and W_a active

**Identity W_a
(Exp M)**



KV passes; W_a is identity (no learned alignment)

**No transfer
(matched single-agent)**



Each agent re-starts; channel removed entirely